



In the verdant surroundings of central Mumbai's Vikhroli, Pirojsha Godrej is in a relaxed mood. The vast campus is synonymous with Godrej and houses multiple group businesses. In many ways, the rich legacy of the group, founded by Ardeshir Godrej, and the contemporary nature of its businesses, make for an interesting blend. It is a past that Pirojsha Godrej speaks about passionately.

In mid-April, he was named Chairperson-designate of Godrej Industries Group, an entity carved out through a restructuring two years ago. He is at present the chairperson of Godrej Properties.

Full of energy, the Godrej family scion is fresh off a presentation, where he outlined the growth strategy that is expected to more than double the market capitalisation to ₹5 lakh crore. The unifying purpose is—Crafting Tomorrow Since 1897 (the year the group came into being).

As he sits down for this interaction, Godrej, 45, displays infectious energy. Acutely aware of the legacy, he seamlessly swerves into how that could help him lay the foundation for the future. Excerpts from an interaction with *Business Today's* Siddharth Zarabi:

Q: You are taking over a storied legacy of 129 years, with the challenge of continuing that and making it relevant to new India. What is at the core of this strategy?

A: It's about being in a relatively unique position of celebrating a legacy and enjoying the advantages of a brand that has been built over the years, a great sense of trust and respect among its customers. That said, the Godrej Industries Group is just two years old in this new format. So, I think the aspiration for the group is to bring together the best of what we've enjoyed in terms of our legacy, but also bring to that a new sense of energy, purpose and ambition, and really combine these two things.

As a group, we have enjoyed a strong track record. We have six operating businesses, with three of them, Godrej Consumer Products, Godrej Properties and Godrej Agrovet, publicly listed, and three, Godrej Capital, Godrej Chemicals and Godrej Ventures, unlisted. Cumulatively, these businesses have, in the past five years, delivered sales and earnings growth of over 20% a year.

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What we would like to do during the next period is to consistently do another five years of over-20% earnings-per-share growth and make sure that we add to that, at the company level, a return on equity of at least 18%.

Q: How much of your legacy businesses will contribute to the targeted market capitalisation of ₹5 lakh crore by 2031? Where do you see new growth opportunities?

A: We have three listed businesses, each of which has tremendous potential. Our FMCG business has a large portfolio of brands. While the industry has been underperforming in the last couple of years, there has been a turnaround in the last few quarters. Regardless of industry performance, we think the brands we have built will lead to a strong performance. Our medium-term aspiration for that business is 10% volume